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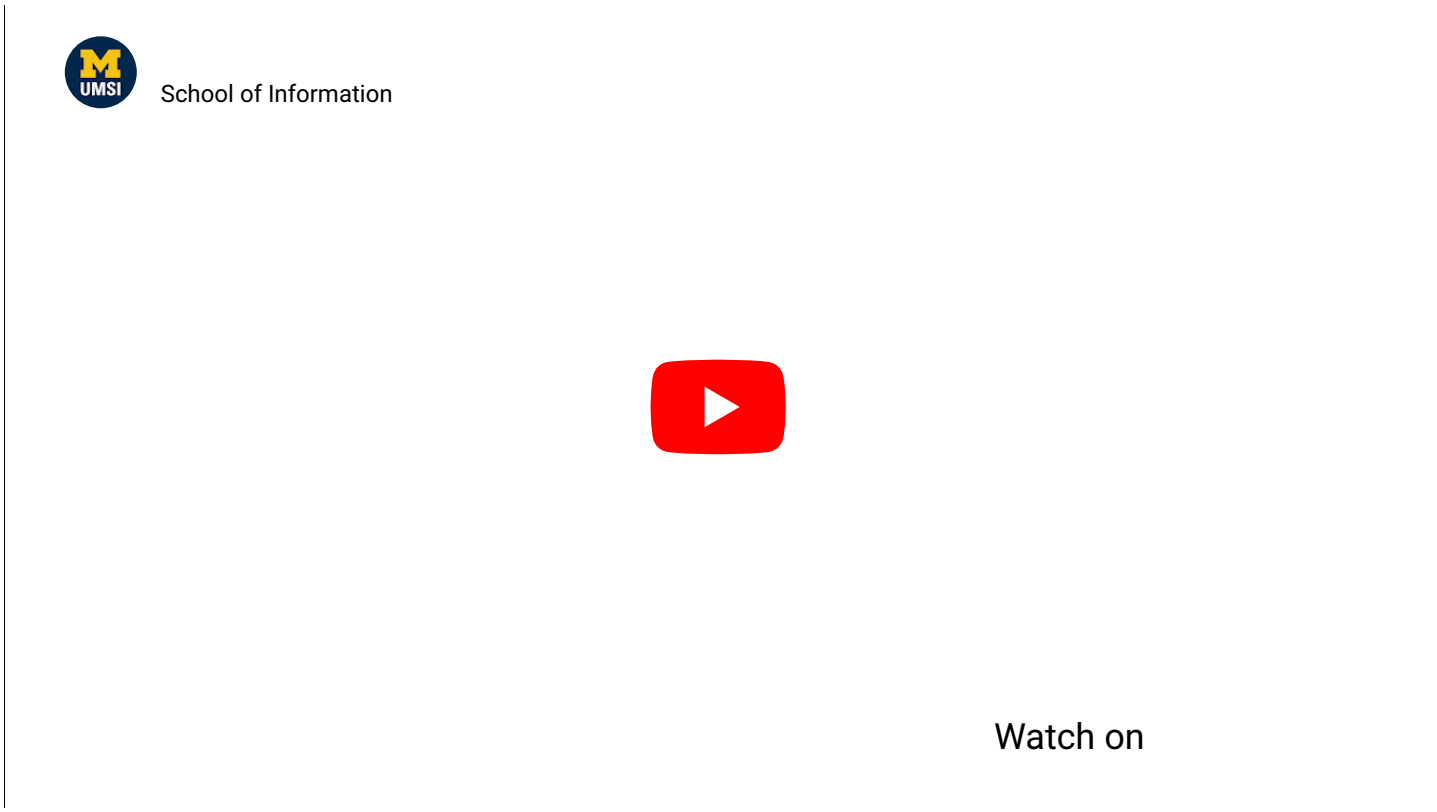
UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

HOME / PROGRAMS / BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN INFORMATION /

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE IN INFORMATION CURRICULUM

Bachelor of Science in Information curriculum



As part of their capstone course, UMSI students teamed up with the Smithsonian Institution to improve their digital museum experience.

Once you've been admitted to the Bachelor of Science in Information program, your coursework will consist of a set of core courses that are required of all BSI students and an individual pathway in Information Analysis or User Experience Design. You will also choose elective courses that interest you, rounding out your academic experience.

Altogether, the BSI degree includes 120 U-M credits (half of which are upper-level credits), and 54 of those credits come from courses offered by the School of Information. All UMSI courses must be taken for a letter grade, achieving a C- or higher, with the exception of SI 210, SI 300 and SI 390. This page will guide you through these degree requirements — and how to select a pathway toward a career in the field.

These degree requirements are for prospective BSI students. Current BSI students: Please make sure to refer to the BSI Academic Advising Resource Site (https://sites.google.com/umich.edu/bsiacademicadvising/bsi-degree-requirements?authuser=0) *for your cohort's specific degree requirements.*

Prerequisite courses

Applicants are required to complete the following prerequisite courses with a grade of C- or higher before entering the BSI program. You can be enrolled in one or both prerequisite courses at the time of your application (or have plans to take them during the summer term), so long as you complete both courses before you begin the BSI program.

- SI 101: Introduction to Programming with Python (4 credits)
  - The equivalent courses EECS 183 and ENGR 101 will fulfill this requirement, though SI 101 is strongly preferred. Please note: These equivalent courses do not count toward your UMSI credit requirement.
  - SI 101 meets the U-M LSA Math and Symbolic Analysis distribution requirement.
- ENGLISH 124 or 125 (or equivalent first-year writing course)
  - Information regarding first-year writing courses can be found on this page. You can also search for first-year writing courses in the LSA course guide by checking First-Year Writing Requirement (FYWR) under the Skills Requirement dropdown menu.

Students who are unable to complete both prerequisite courses before enrolling in the program should contact umsi.undergrad@umich.edu (mailto:umsi.undergrad@umich.edu) in order to determine if there is an alternative option.

Core courses

- SI 110: Introduction to Information Studies (4 credits)
- SI 201: Data-Oriented Programming (4 credits, counts as upper-level credit)
  - The successful completion of EECS 280 or EECS 281 with a grade of C or higher will waive this requirement. Please note: These courses do not count toward your UMSI or upper-level credit requirements.
- SI 261: Introduction to Statistics with Applications (3 credits, counts as upper-level credit)
- SI 300: Career and Internship Studio: Design Your Success (1 credit)
- SI 310: Introduction to Information Ethics (3 credits)

Pathways of study

The BSI offers two pathways, Information Analysis and User Experience Design, and students are required to complete one. A pathway is an area of concentration in advanced courses, allowing for depth in a chosen area of study.

Information Analysis pathway

Information Analysis pathway

If you choose Information Analysis, you'll complete courses that teach you to identify and ask questions that matter to stakeholders, gather essential data to answer these questions, find answers that are grounded in empirical evidence and present those answers in a convincing way.

Information Analysis students take the following courses:

Capstone prerequisite courses

- SI 315: Models of Social Information Processing (4 credits)
- SI 305: Introduction to Information Analysis (3 credits)
- SI 345: Data Manipulation (4 credits)
- SI 385: Data Exploration (3 credits, fall only)
- SI 425: Introduction to User Modeling (3 credits, fall only)

Capstone sequence*

In your final year of the IA pathway, you will complete a pair of capstone courses that allow you to apply your knowledge and skills.

- SI 485: Information Analysis Capstone 1 (2 credits, fall only)
- SI 495: Information Analysis Capstone II (4 credits, winter only)

*must be taken in direct sequence

Selective prerequisites

IA students must select **one course** from this list of prerequisites to advanced coursework:

- SI 325: Mathematics for Information Analysis (3 credits, fall only)
- SI 303: Introduction to Qualitative Methods/Research (3 credits)

Advanced selectives*

IA students must select **two courses** from this list of advanced coursework:

- SI 405: Applied Generative AI (4 credits)
- SI 465: Applied Machine Learning (4 credits)
- SI 403: Advanced Qualitative Methods/Research (4 credits)
- SI 413: Advanced Quantitative Methods/Research (4 credits)

*winter only

User Experience (UX) Design pathway

If you choose User Experience Design, you'll complete courses that teach you to design, build and evaluate compelling interactive systems. The philosophy of the pathway is user-centered design — that is, that designers of computing systems need to take account of, and even prioritize, the needs and experiences of any system's users.

User Experience Design students take the following courses:

Capstone prerequisite courses*

- SI 307: Introduction to Design (3 credits)
- SI 357: Introduction to Development (3 credits)
- SI 347: Human-Computer Interaction (3 credits)
- SI 303: Introduction to Qualitative Methods/Research (3 credits)
- SI 313: Introduction to Quantitative Methods/Research (3 credits)

*must be taken for a letter grade

Capstone sequence

In your final year of the UX Design pathway, you will complete a pair of capstone courses that allow you to apply your knowledge and skills:

- SI 487: User Experience Design Capstone I (2 credits, fall only)
- SI 497: User Experience Design Capstone II (4 credits, winter only)

*must be taken in direct sequence

Advanced selectives

UX students must select **two courses** from this list of advanced coursework:

- SI 407: Advanced Design (4 credits, fall only)
- SI 457: Advanced Development (4 credits)
- SI 403: Advanced Qualitative Methods/Research (4 credits)
- SI 413: Advanced Quantitative Methods/Research (4 credits, winter only)

School of Information

Watch on

Electives

The BSI program is designed to provide flexibility for selecting additional courses that interest you. You can select any courses outside of your pathway requirements — including courses from another curricular pathway — to round out your 54 required UMSI credits. Visit the School of Information's course catalog (https://www.si.umich.edu/programs/courses) to browse the complete list of BSI course offerings.

Minors

The School of Information recognizes most minors offered by the University of Michigan. While enrolled in the BSI program, if you discover that you would like to pursue a minor, please work with your academic advisor.

Dual degrees

Students who wish to pursue two degrees, one from the School of Information and the second from a different college at U-M, should plan to meet with both academic advisors. UMSI currently has dual degrees approved with the College of Literature, Science and the Arts; the Ross School of Business; the College of Engineering; the School of Music, Theatre & Dance; the School of Kinesiology; and the Penny W. Stamps School of Art and Design.

Sign up for our interest list and receive:

- Invitations to exclusive information sessions and events
- The opportunity to chat with current students
- More in-depth information about the BSI program
- Tips and advice for creating a successful application
- Reminders for important deadlines

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UMSI RECOMMENDED STUDENT LAPTOP SPECIFICATIONS >

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